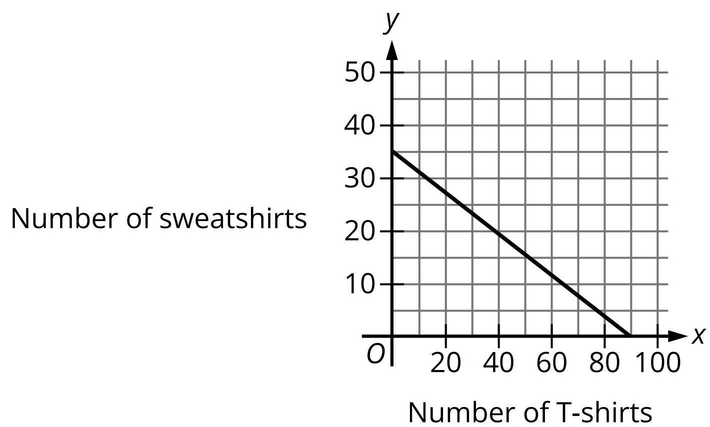
Question ID: 00b9bd37

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	Medium

Question



The graph models the relationship between the number of T-shirts, x, and the number of sweatshirts, y, that Kira can purchase for a school fundraiser. Which equation could represent this relationship?

Answer

A. $y = 7x + 18$

B. $7x + 18y = 630$

C. $y = 18x + 7$

D. $18x + 7y = 630$

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. A line in the *xy*-plane can be written as $y = mx + b$, where m is the slope of the line and b is the *y*-coordinate of the *y*-intercept. The graph shown is a line passing through the points $(0, 35)$ and $(90, 0)$. Substituting 0 for x and 35 for y in the equation $y = mx + b$ yields $35 = m(0) + b$, or $35 = b$. Substituting 35 for b, 90 for x, and 0 for y in the equation $y = mx + b$ yields $0 = 90m + 35$. Subtracting 35 from both sides of this equation yields $-35 = 90m$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 90 yields $-\frac{35}{90} = m$, or $-\frac{7}{18} = m$. Substituting $-\frac{7}{18}$ for m and 35 for b in the equation $y = mx + b$ yields $y = -\frac{7}{18}x + 35$. Multiplying both sides of this equation by 18 yields $18y = -7x + 35(18)$, or $18y = -7x + 630$. Adding $7x$ to both sides of this equation yields $7x + 18y = 630$. Therefore, the equation $7x + 18y = 630$ represents the relationship between x and y modeled by the graph.

Choice A is incorrect. The point $(0, 35)$ is not on the graph of this equation, since $7(0) + 18 = 18$, not 35.

Choice C is incorrect. The point $(0, 35)$ is not on the graph of this equation, since $18(0) + 7 = 7$, not 35.

Choice D is incorrect. The point $(90, 0)$ is not on the graph of this equation, since $18(90) + 7(0) = 1{,}620$, not 630.